

The Boston Globe

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FRIDAY, MAY 8, 2026

Squarely in Copley's corner



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF



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GLOBE FILE

Copley Square Park has changed over the years (above right, lunch hour in 1971), and now features a new layout with less grass and many more places to relax, as well as a path cutting through (top, above left).

The revitalized park, with more trees and benches, could be a perfect space for everyone

I was prepared to rag on the new Copley Square Park. In my youth, I spent some time lolling about on the lawn that filled the square, before the city's recently completed, \$19 million renovation. I have fond memories of being among the carefree crowds enjoying concerts and other events there. How lovely it was to have that vast expanse of open space in one of Boston's most hectic crossroads, surrounded by the city's most gorgeous architecture. Those were the days! So it would be easy to hate the reconfig-

YVONNE ABRAHAM COMMENTARY

ured Copley, which now has less lawn, more paving, and a pedestrian thoroughfare through its middle. They paved my paradise. Booo! But you know what? I actually kind of love it. I spent hours there on Tuesday afternoon, taking the place in from various angles, watching how locals and tourists are using the space. And they were actually using it.

Good job, everybody! Maybe everywhere was bound to feel like heaven on one of the first, long-overdue warm, cloudless days of the year. Maybe anything would look great after the ripped-up square the city endured for more than two years. But on Tuesday afternoon, the new park felt dynamic, magnetic, and interesting. You can watch the whole world pass by on the path that cuts through the park, from the corner of Boylston and Clarendon at one end, to the corner of Dartmouth and Hun-

ABRAHAM, Page A6

Minogue pushing to clear GOP field

Despite pressure to drop out, Shortsleeve aims for primary

By Kelly Garrity and Chris Van Buskirk
GLOBE STAFF

Mike Minogue, the state Republican Party's newly endorsed gubernatorial candidate, has said he's running to be a "new kind of governor" for Massachusetts. He and his supporters are suddenly running a new kind of race, too: a pressure campaign to squeeze his lone remaining Republican rival out of the primary. Minogue, a former executive of a medical device company, is already airing what he billed as "general election" ads and has challenged Governor Maura Healey to debates. Party leaders and activists are urging colleagues to rally behind him, in a tacit nudge to Brian Shortsleeve to end his own campaign for the nomination. And a GOP-endorsed candidate for another statewide office has openly urged him to drop out ahead of the Sept. 1 vote, adding to the messy internal divisions slicing through the party. "The path to defeating Healey in November runs through unity," more than 60 state GOP state committee members and Republican town and city chairs wrote in an open letter circulating among other party members, urging them to line up behind Minogue. "Every week spent relitigating the convention, or contesting a primary, is a week not spent registering voters, recruiting volunteers, and building the coordinated campaign

PRIMARY, Page A5

Women work to make a place in AI explosion

By Aaron Pressman
GLOBE STAFF

Reese Witherspoon ignited a controversy over artificial intelligence last month, after she urged women to get up to speed on AI tools. While some embraced the advice, others hectored the Hollywood star and producer for failing to mention the threats posed by AI. But months before Witherspoon made headlines, women in Boston's tech scene were doing more than just calling for action. Some have launched buzzy grass-roots efforts, where AI-savvy women are teaching other women about the topic and how to use the latest apps. The focus isn't just on gender equity or representation. Silicon Valley is already plunging ahead on AI. The emerging movement in Boston — with the area's long history of activism, ideas, and intellectual debate — is more about building an inclusive culture around AI that accounts for who will be impacted by the technology, and who gets to decide. The new efforts come amid research (cited by Witherspoon) that women's jobs are more at risk from AI while at the same time they have less influence over its development and use. A study from the Brookings Institution released in January found that among the roles most at risk due to generative AI, 86 percent of the workers are women.

AI, Page A6

Rise in emergency responses at jail raises questions

By Danny McDonald
GLOBE STAFF

The number of people in a Boston jail who need emergency health care has been skyrocketing: Ambulance transports shot up by nearly half last year, to 328, and have tripled since 2010, records show. Exactly what's driving the trend is hard to say. A vague term — "illness" — was cited in the largest

share of incidents at the Nashua Street Jail that required a response from Boston Emergency Medical Services. The next most common category, "other," can include a range of physical maladies and behavioral problems. The records also show a sharp increase in the number of EMS responses prompted by injuries. Such visits have tripled since 2023 and

reached 54 last year, the highest total in the last decade and a half. The worrying new data come at a time of turmoil at the Suffolk County Sheriff's Department, which oversees the jail. Advocates said the numbers raise a range of serious concerns. "It causes us to immediately question if there have been increases in staff brutality, failures to ade-

quately treat substance use disorders, mental health needs, or if there have been other increases in deficient medical care," said Dave Rini, executive director of Prisoners' Legal Services of Massachusetts. The sheriff's department did not respond to written questions from the Globe about the increases in injuries. A spokesperson blamed vari-

JAIL, Page A7

'Pulling the rug out in the middle of the spring term . . . is a very surprising move.'

RL GOLDBERG, an assistant professor of queer and trans studies

Hampshire faculty, staff say they were misled

Little notice of impending closure

By Brooke Hauser and Hilary Burns
GLOBE STAFF

NORTHAMPTON — When Gaurav Jashnani was offered a position as an assistant professor at Hampshire College, he saw it as a good move: Even though the iconoclastic liberal arts school doesn't have a tenure system, the job would put him on a forward-moving track at a forward-looking institution. So in 2024, he relocated his family from Belmont to Northampton,

where he became a first-time homeowner. Now, less than a month after Hampshire announced it would close, he's staring down unemployment. Like most of the school's roughly 250 employees, he will have no paycheck, no severance, and few job prospects after June, since the hiring cycle for the coming academic year has already closed. "It's been kind of a train wreck," said Jashnani, who

HAMPSHIRE COLLEGE, Page A7



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

Sarah E. Jenkins, an assistant professor, said Hampshire College administrators probably did too much budgeting with "the best-case scenario" in mind.



Good, bad, ugly

Friday: Seasonable. High 59-64. Low 44-49.
Saturday: Rain moves in. High 56-61. Low 49-54.
Sunrise: 5:30 Sunset: 7:51
Weather and Comics, G6-7. Obituaries, C9.

VOL. 309, NO. 128
*
Suggested retail price
\$4.00



The SJC gave Attorney General Andrea Campbell 30 days to decide whether she will represent Auditor Diana DiZoglio in court in DiZoglio's quest to audit the Legislature. **B1.**

The US military said it intercepted Iranian attacks on three Navy ships in the Strait of Hormuz. **A3.**

The Green Line station at Symphony Hall will be closed for nearly three years for construction. **B1.**

Fidelity Investments plans to hire more than 5,000 workers but also shed about 1,000 jobs. **B5.**

Florida has created a new American history course that advances a more conservative interpretation. **A2.**